compared with life in the White House, especially after the shooting at the Hilton.

No matter what we did or where we went, elaborate security arrangements were required, and usually had to be planned out weeks in advance. Every time we went out, it was in a caravan of five or six cars behind a blizzard of red lights and screaming sirens. Even if the Secret Service allowed us to go to church, we'd arrive there in a siren-screaming motorcade accompanied by legions of reporters and security people. No longer was going to church a pleasant Sunday morning experience, it was a news event: The other people in the church would have to pass through a magnetometer before they could get in; and once we were seated in church, Nancy and I often felt uncomfortable because so many people in the other pews were looking at us instead of listening to the sermon.

Things got worse after we started getting reports of terrorist hit squads. We were told that our going to church might result in an assassination attempt that could cause the deaths of many other people there. Very unhappily, we just had to stop going to church altogether, and we really missed it.

Even inside the White House, our movements were limited. I had to avoid getting too close to certain windows because of the possibility of sharpshooters and, except at a few spots surrounded by hedges or buildings, we couldn't go for a walk on the White House grounds because we would be exposed to buildings from which a gunman might take aim.

I'm really not complaining, though. There were plenty of things to compensate for the freedom we lost, one of the greatest being Camp David—a slice of heaven a half hour's helicopter ride from the White House where we spent many weekends surrounded by 150 acres of beautiful woods.